

Right The *bouchons* of Lyon promise an old-fashioned warmth along with unpretentious, hearty regional food

Below *Saucisson chaud à la lyonnaise* is a simple dish of poached pork sausage and warm, dressed potato salad



A Day in Lyon

Old Lyon is a UNESCO World Heritage site, full of medieval churches and Renaissance buildings, and its narrow streets are full of surprises.

MORNING Explore the city's *traboules* (hidden passageways linking ancient streets). Map in hand, set out from **Place St Paul** in Old Lyon to explore the cobbled lanes. Visit **Cathédrale St-Jean** to admire the stained glass and the astronomical clock.

AFTERNOON Look for the giant modern murals that are splashed across Lyon, sometimes covering whole buildings. The architecture-rich **Presqu'île** area has some of the best, including **Fresque des Lyonnais**, picturing Lyonnais celebrities, and the nearby **Bibliothèque de la Cité**, where huge books decorate the building.

EVENING Take the funicular up to the gilt-rich basilica of **Nôtre Dame de Fourvière**, built in the 1870s on the site of a Roman temple. Alongside are two 12th-century chapels, and there's a sweeping view of the whole city from the terrace.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

There are **flights** (Lyon-Saint Exupéry Airport) and **high-speed trains** to Lyon from many European cities. The city has an efficient **tram**, **train**, and **bus** network, and free **bicycle** rental.

WHERE TO STAY

Collège Hotel (inexpensive) is a quirky school-themed hotel with all-white decor. www.college-hotel.com

Artelit Chambres d'Hôtes (moderate) has romantic rooms in a 16th-century building with a pink tower in Old Lyon. www.dormiralyon.com

Villa Florentine (expensive) is a restored 17th-century convent with a city panorama that's hard to top. www.villaflorentine.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

Place Bellecour; www.lyon-france.com

